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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, October 15, 2020

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dfe_FD2V8Sw
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:00] able to see. Yes. Seeing is important. Okay. I'll talk to you later. Okay. So I'm further down on the list, right, Em? You are first on action agenda. Oh. So you're further on the list, but the first five or six are consent. So I'm actually first. Yeah. Yep. We always do the best first, Kristonya. Oh, there you go. How are you, Mr. Gecker? Good. How are you? Please call me, Dan.

[00:00:41] Great. So just to let everybody know, we are live streaming on YouTube. We're waiting for folks to get on, and then we'll get started right at 10. Great. Great. I'll go ahead and just pull up the title slide just so folks know. Okay. Title slide for the for the board meeting just so folks know that this is the right one. We are going to get started here in just a minute and Dan I'll pull

[00:01:20] this down as soon as we as soon as we have everybody on. Good morning everybody. Morning Dr. Wilson. Good morning. I will say you did an excellent job chairing the meeting yesterday.

[00:01:42] you did well well thank you i was glad to be able to to help i hope keisha's feeling a little better today unfortunately she's not she's actually not going to be able to join us um but probably for the best yeah she you know i think she powered through yesterday um she just needs to rest yeah yeah my cat is mad at me i made her stay outside the room today since she - She likes to get up on the screen.

[00:02:22] - I feel like every time we have a meeting, she wants to be front and center. - Yeah, like I've said before, great disdain for me, except when I'm on Zoom. - Yeah, she just wants to be the star. - Wants to show off her cuteness, as we used to say about the kids.

[00:02:39] - Yeah. - Except when you want them to show off their kids, and then they become shy. - Dr. Mann, good morning. - Good morning.

[00:02:57] - Self-situated. Good morning. Good morning, Sonia. Good morning, Dr. Duran. Good morning. How are you today?

[00:03:34] Good. Good morning, Ms. Hulton. Good morning. Ms. Hulton is back and outside again. I am. It's just too good. If I've got to work, I might as well enjoy the fresh air, though. That reminds me. I'll put my earphones in so you don't have to hear the mowing, etc. The birds, you won't mind.

[00:03:57] yeah are we public yet yes we're live thank you good morning everyone morning fam how are you

[00:04:39] very well i hope you guys are too fam are you strategically situated on a hill across from the school or what it's it that that is a very old photo can yeah that tree is no longer there and

[00:05:05] that marquee is no longer on the wall but it is what it is very proud of it good morning everybody

[00:06:14] for those joining just want to let you know that we are live on youtube and we will get uh started

[00:06:20] here in just a couple of minutes it's another morning that i miss our meeting room uh it would

[00:07:31] be nice to get together again fairly soon now with your banner background we can't tell what setting you're in so i hope you're somewhere comfortable oh yeah in the home office but it's uh like the rest of everything you know a mess just to use the backgrounds it saves putting things in the cabinets you know you must be like me dan i have to have everything spread out it is all spread out

[00:08:03] and it is a complete mess but organized mess exactly i can tell you where everything is this is susan williams i just wanted to say good morning to everyone good morning susan how are you

[00:08:21] i'm doing just fine how are you good thank you good morning susan good morning all right i got it at 10. i see dr lane is joined emily i think we've got everybody who's coming right yep i think

[00:08:55] we are all here i'm going to go ahead and stop my share screen so we can see everyone's video wow um and i we're all set turn it over to you good thanks uh then we'll call the meeting of the the board to order. First thing is the roll call. Ms. Holton? Aye. Present.

[00:09:21] Stavis Vaught? Present. Dr. Duran? Present. Dr. Wilson? Present. And Dr. Mann? Present. Excellent. As I said coming into this, you know, I still am missing the in-person meetings and the time we've had together. I'm hopeful that y'all are staying safe and, you know, one day soon we'll be able to get together as a board in person. In any event, good morning. Welcome to the Board of Education's virtual meeting. Our meeting today is being streamed live on the

[00:09:58] VDOE YouTube channel and on the board's public meeting webpage. We'd like to welcome those joining us on the live stream from across the Commonwealth. A couple of things to note about our virtual meeting. The board has accepted written public comment for this meeting. All comments that

were received by 5 p.m. on Tuesday have been uploaded to our meeting web page and shared with board members in time for them to review in advance of today's meeting. Comments received after 5 p.m. on Tuesday will be provided to the board in a timely manner. For our YouTube watchers, the chat feature is disabled as it is not monitored by staff. The best way to contact

[00:10:38] the board is by email at B, that's as in boy or board, OE at DOE, as in department of education since we are meeting virtually we will do a roll call vote for each item please be sure to speak clearly so that the staff can accurately capture your vote for the meeting minutes before we move to the consent agenda i do want to recognize that we have a resolution to commemorate november 2020 as family engagement and education month and i guess a lot of our families have engaged more

[00:11:11] in education than they ever expected to not just this month but since march the board of education believes that families and schools working together can create meaningful relationships that lead to significant gains in student achievement and success. Over 30 years of research clearly indicates all students achieve at higher levels when schools and families support each other.

[00:11:34] Family Involvement and Education Month is an opportunity to recognize the importance of families and schools and the work being done throughout the Commonwealth to ensure that we work together to build better futures for all children. It is also an opportunity to recognize that as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic and its impact on the operation of our public and private schools, parents have had to take on a more direct role in the education of their children. The board and the Virginia Department of Education strongly encourage local school officials to develop plans and policies to enhance family engagement in their

[00:12:08] children's schools, lives, and in the education community. Okay, so that covers that resolution. item g on the consent agenda we're going to have a couple of recusals uh so can we get a motion to adopt uh excuse me let me do the approval of minutes which i tend to forget uh is there has everybody had a chance to read the september 16 and september 17 minutes of the board uh if so

[00:12:46] is there a motion to approve or any alternative a motion to approve with corrections i missed that one. Pam? Thank you. Tammy seconds. Perfect. I'm glad somebody's paying attention. All right. We have a motion to second. Oh, can't do that anymore either. All right. Roll call. Ms. Holton? Aye.

[00:13:12] Ms. Davis-Vaught? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. And chair votes aye. Okay. The consent agenda, as I just mentioned, item G will have some recusals for different pieces.

[00:13:29] uh so uh is there a motion to adopt items a through f and of course a is the resolution that we just discussed so moved thank you dr duran is there a second second thank you dr wilson uh again roll call miss holton hi miss davis vaught i dr duran hi dr wilson i uh and dr man

[00:13:59] okay uh for item g uh let's separate out uh i guess george mason and university of richmond uh is there a motion to approve all the items on item g other than uh you are and george mason motion to thank you miss davis vought is there a second second okay i think dr man

[00:14:33] Great. Okay. Roll call on this. Ms. Houlton. Aye. Ms. Davis-Vaught. Aye. Dr. Duran. Aye. Dr. Wilson. Aye. Dr. Mann. Aye. And I vote aye. Okay. A motion to approve the new education endorsement programs at George Mason. I believe Ms. Houlton will recuse. Yes. Is there a motion for that? So moved. Thank you, Dr. Wilson. Is there a second? Second. Second. Thank you, Dr. Ms. Davis-Vaught. Again, roll call.

[00:15:08] As I said, Ms. Halton's recused, well, Ms. Halton, you're recused. Ms. Davis-Vaught? Yes, Carruth. Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. And I vote aye, and now a motion to approve the new education endorsement program at University of Richmond.

[00:15:28] So moved. Thank you, Dr. Duran. Is there a second? Second. Thank you, Ms. Davis-Vaught, again by roll call. Ms. Halton? Aye. Ms. Davis-Vaught? Aye. Dr. Duran? Dr. Mann, I'm assuming Dr. Wilson you are recusing and I vote aye. Okay, so that all carries. All right, a quick move from A to G and now we move on to H and begin I guess the real business of the meeting. Final review of the proposed recommendations by the governor's

[00:16:06] commission on African-American history education in Virginia. Ms. Brown. Good morning. Good morning. how are you mr gecker dr wilson dr lane members of the board thank you so much for taking the time to um hear our presentation it is my pleasure to bring to you for final review the recommendations for edits for the governor's commission on african-american history education in virginia

[00:16:36] thank you emily next slide as you may remember from the september meeting we discussed the work of the standards subcommittee led by Dr. Cassandra Nubia-Alexander and specifically their recommendations regarding the process, standards reorganization, and technical edits. Next slide.

[00:17:02] The technical edits work group led by Dr. Ed Ayers was given direction and definition as they reviewed the curriculum frameworks for Virginia Studies, United States History to 1865, United States history, 1865 to the present, and Virginia and U.S. history. Next slide.

[00:17:28] Those recommendations were reviewed by department staff from various offices as you can see listed there and then they were sent to the superintendent and senior leadership for review of the document and it included the original language from the curriculum frameworks from 2015, the edits as recommended by the commission, the type of edit in DOE suggestions, and then recommended action.

[00:18:01] Next slide. At the September 17th board meeting, staff presented subcommittee's recommendations organized in two categories, with the caveat that the department staff would further review the recommendations from category two and may make additional changes to incorporate the content into the curriculum frameworks next slide since the september 17th meeting department staff did review

[00:18:37] the recommendations and placed that were placed in category 2 and incorporated many of the recommendations in different locations of the curriculum frameworks we also received and reviewed feedback from the virginia tribal education consortium and then took all of the recommendations from category two that were placed in different locations of the curriculum frameworks back to the historians from the standard subcommittee for their discussion then lastly

[00:19:16] we also developed a projected timeline for the review and revision process that's upcoming so at this time what i would like to do is to go through the different attachments that are attached to the boilerplate to give you a little bit more in-depth idea of what was done.

[00:19:34] So attachment A is the entire curriculum frameworks with all of the changes, recommendations from the commission. Next slide. In particular, we brought up to you at the September 17th meeting a standard, as an example, VUS 6D. The subcommittee, if you wouldn't mind clicking,

[00:20:04] emily the subcommittee thank you and click once more thank you go back the subcommittee made a recommendation um for this particular standard that had a lot of content um for the essential understanding this was an example of a recommendation that we placed in category two

[00:20:34] next slide once we reviewed and click again emily there it is once we reviewed the content we were able to move the content that was recommended into a different location for the curriculum framework for instructional flow and clarity for teachers. Next slide. Upon further

[00:21:13] review, the department reorganized the recommendations again for instructional flow and clarity, and I apologize for the plane that's going over right now, for instructional flow and clarity of the content attachment b is a chart that outlines all of the changes for the curriculum frameworks department staff will use this chart to populate resources for teachers schools school divisions as they incorporate the changes into their local division curriculum we have recommended

[00:21:47] we have recommendations presented by the commission in the history and social science program will be meeting with the Virginia Social Studies Leaders Consortium next week to discuss their support in populating this chart. This organization, in full support of the recommendations, is comprised of social studies division leaders, museums, and organizations with a history and social science purpose. Attachment C identifies those items that were recommended by the standard

[00:22:25] subcommittee but will be considered for the upcoming review and revision process as many of them require additional research and or input from affiliate organizations or groups next slide thank you attachment d is a little different this is for the board's consideration as it is outside

[00:22:59] of the official review and revision process attachment d proposes an additional substandard for virginia u.s. 0.8 this particular substandard would specifically discuss lynching asking students to analyze the impact of lynching and the racial terror on the lives of african americans and explain the efforts used to combat widespread lynching taking place in the 1890s and beyond as the committee's recommendations were incorporated and can be found in attachment a

[00:23:39] as they recommended them we are proposing that this content was duplicated in the middle school history course and the same was put into the high school history course with this proposal of this standard substandard it considers the difference in content depth and skill level it also provides an opportunity for deeper exploration and synthesis of evidence from primary and secondary sources

[00:24:12] if you wouldn't mind clicking once emily thank you so this content again proposes an opportunity for deeper exploration over the past 102 years there has been over 200 pieces of legislation proposed to combat lynching on at the national level the content added in this particular substandard would give students in the high school history course an opportunity to explore

[00:24:45] not only the past but the relevancy of the present again the original recommendation has been incorporated in the curriculum frameworks for U.S. History, 1865 to the present, and Virginia and U.S. History. But again, the content that they recommended was a duplicate of one another. That's why we are proposing the attachment D. Attachment E outlines a projected

[00:25:19] timeline for the upcoming review and revision process, but it also includes the communications and the implementation of the subcommittee's recommendations for edits. It also includes the expansion of the review and revision process. And lastly, it proposes streamlining the

documents for the review and revision process of the standards and the curriculum framework to be done simultaneously. Next slide. So our next steps, upon your approval, the department

[00:25:56] will communicate the edits to the school divisions through a superintendent's memo. we will continue to develop and reflect on the edits by developing resources working with again the social studies leaders consortium and posting those resources on the doe website as well as go open va to share with all educators even though these are edits for history and social science many of the resources can be used in other courses or even disciplines and lastly we are

[00:26:33] planning on providing a variety of professional development that will help teachers in schools and school divisions implement these changes next slide so therefore the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education approve the recommendations from the governor's commission on african-american history education in virginia at this time the team and i will entertain any questions that you might have let me just ask one uh we got a decent amount of public

[00:27:11] comment on this if you had a chance to review that public comment uh there were some specific factual issues raised in some of the public comment uh have we as the department had a chance to vet those the um specifically there was one that came directly to me and that was from mr Bronlick and I did have an opportunity on Tuesday to speak with Mr. Bronlick and his comments I was able to reconnect with Dr. Ayers and Dr. Cassandra Nubia-Alexander and I believe

[00:27:48] that comment their response to his his particular public comment was forwarded to Emily if I'm not mistaken. None of what he has proposed would be incorporated right now, but would be considered for the review and revision process. Anyone else would like to add to that? Okay.

[00:28:19] Ms. Houlton. Ms. Houlton, then Dr. Mann. Yes, ma'am. Dr. Wilson also then. Ms. Houlton first. Thank you, Kristania. Very, very helpful. As I understand it, there are changes. Well, I don't completely understand it. So there are changes in three categories. One is the curriculum framework changes that we're making revisions we're making immediately. One is a category of

[00:28:51] changes that will be considered as part of the ongoing standards and curriculum framework review, which you provided the schedule for, and that's very helpful. And then this third, this item, D, I think it is, attachment D, the lynching piece, is that an actual change to the standard or is that curriculum framework or help me understand that one and why is that one different from the other two categories? Yes, ma'am. That is a change to the standard. It's adding a substandard

[00:29:27] to vus.8 which originally goes a through f and we are proposing adding eight point on vus.8g as an additional substandard but if you do not want to do that the content for lynching has been put into the curriculum frameworks now the only difference is the recommendation that the committee proposed was the same content for the middle school course as it was for the high school course.

[00:30:04] So because that was a duplicate in the content that was being proposed, we are proposing to add a substandard to differentiate the content on lynching from middle school to high school. That's what you find in attachment D. So if I understand correctly, sort of big picture, There was that this there was a standard that talked about the era of reconstruction, but did not have anything in the standards specifically about lynching.

[00:30:35] Yes, and the Commission has recommended appropriately that there should be something about lynching in the standards. JoAnne Hanrahan: And so, unlike with some of the other changes that are

going to need to go through the longer process where your recommendation that the recommendation that's before us is to accelerate a change to the standards to put the lynching piece in the standard itself.

[00:31:01] JoAnne Hanrahan: Now, yes, and and it will also be in the curriculum framework and differentiate at different grades as a program. JoAnne Hanrahan: Yes, ma'am. JoAnne Hanrahan: Is that okay okay great. add to that maybe a way to conceptualize this in the simplest form is we're essentially asking you to adopt attachment a which includes everything in the framework and then once you've made the determination on option a you you have the option to consider whether you want to add to the standard we wanted you to handle the framework first because that's what's in front of you

[00:31:38] and knowing that the board may not want to adjust the standards because it's outside we actually see that as a separate motion and a separate debate for the board but the the first debate is around framework which is attachment a but but are they both before us today yes they're both before you today but the the board the board gave us direction last month to only focus on the framework to change the standards and so we gave you an option to make one small change to the standards but the framework attachment a is the main core recommendation i i understand but i i

[00:32:16] i sure think that the omission that the lack of any specific reference to lynching in the standards does seem like a matter of some urgency and i would certainly be supportive of addressing it right away and so as i understand it if we address uh uh attachment d that would be addressing one piece of the standards right now in um in uh but uh and that the rest of the standards would would continue with the regular review process or the the review process um on the schedule that

[00:32:52] christiania has outlined um and if i if i'm correct in understanding that there so i hear you there's two separate recommendations the brick on framework and then the standards revision and then there are other changes that will be continue to be considered over the course of the next year or so as we revisit both the standards and the curriculum framework that sort of tripartite approach uh have uh have we shared that with uh the leadership of the commission and some of the other stakeholder groups i'm thinking specifically some of the legislators that had reached out to us

[00:33:30] and are have we had any feedback are they comfortable with that approach or did they have any suggestions the feedback that we received on attachment d came from the leaders of the standard subcommittee and they were perfectly fine with the content of attachment d i did go through the content that they proposed and then the content that is proposed in attachment d and they they were perfectly fine with that but then on the process the overall approach of some

[00:34:08] some changes now in the curriculum framework this change in the standards potentially now and then other things to be reviewed ongoing that sort of approach overall did they have any feedback on that no ma'am but we're getting an opportunity yes oh yes we spoke to the leadership uh with the team in fact i just got a text message from leah she spoke with the leadership as recently as tuesday and they were fine with the approach on the recommendations um so and then uh we received a letter from the um legislative black caucus mr gecker and i both

[00:34:46] responded with with what we were doing um they they have not necessarily responded back so i wouldn't say that that's approval or or denial in any way but i um we we we've we've been in conversation with that uh the legislative black caucus as well that's that answers my question thank you dr wilson or i guess dr mann i'm sorry and then dr wilson oh no that's fine actually my question piggybacks on mrs

holton's question and i think what's material for me and this is that you've articulated through your thoughtful presentation thank you for that that in fact

[00:35:23] this content and attachment d shows up elsewhere so it is not uh it is different from the content that's flowing in attachment c that's going to be undertaken at a future date but that this content already lived so creating it as a sub bullet a sub content area um it's not in effect creating new content outside of a process where you've already identified where other things are going to have to be handled down the line with the full-on revision process is that right that's correct

[00:35:56] yes ma'am thank you dr wilson thank you president gecker thank you ms brown for your um presentation i do have several questions that are actually related uh primarily to helping remind us about our typical process okay so how can you remind us how often uh are the is the framework revisited and changes recommended and or made in any other circumstance well this um this is unprecedented

[00:36:31] with the recommendations from the commission the curriculum framework is reviewed and revised every seven years right after the standards document is approved by the board in my tenure here at the department i've never really encountered anything like this where we have made changes to the curriculum framework outside of the revision process so this is kind of unprecedented but the curriculum framework for technical edits since i've been in education i believe there for history

[00:37:10] and social science i can speak to there have been probably about three different instances where we've had to either update the curriculum framework because there have been changes for example with the changes of where you can register the vote that was something through legislation the curriculum framework had to be updated so we've we've i've never really encountered and maybe michael or shelly can speak to um that happening in the past but from my recollection it's probably

[00:37:49] been about three or four times and they were very small we've not had um changes like this since I've been at the department. But we have had changes. We have had changes, yes ma'am. So so that's one question. Second question is you mentioned the number of shifts and changes and the reorganization and putting things in different places. So I think about our teachers who are working with the revisions and confusion, potential confusion. I heard you talk about

[00:38:23] professional development and the resources that will be available so can you expand a little bit on when resource when we expect resources to be available to our teachers and how we would anticipate helping them manage through and understand i understand your meeting i think you said next week with leaders in content so so can you talk a little bit about how we are going about supporting teachers who will be asked to implement or given this resource really right

[00:38:56] your use as um again in speaking with the social studies leaders um next week many of them are right on board and they are working with their teams right now to revise their local curriculum we are anticipating having something posted for teachers by the beginning of the next calendar year to give us enough time to gather those resources and also vet those resources we're looking for specialists to develop activities that will go along with those resources so that

[00:39:34] may take some time school divisions will be encouraged to incorporate this new content into their local curriculum now um even though school has started but it it will be an expectation that the 2021-2022 school year that is fully implemented into their local curriculum the changes knowing that we're kind

of starting late in a sense the school has already started and courses have already started with um content and some of the content that was added had to do with

[00:40:14] for example the arrival of the first africans to british north america for many courses they've moved past that standard so rather than trying to get them to go back and reteach it's understandable that they just can't do that and also they would need resources to help them with that so second semester there are quite a few standards where changes have been made that they can teach this content starting with the second semester but we're definitely encouraging them to look at the changes

[00:40:50] now and incorporate it into their local curriculum but it will be the expectation that starting with the full next school year that they have made those changes to their local curriculum and are incorporating it into their instructional plan okay so the key dates i heard you say was january 2021 resources identified and in place and then um implementation beginning in the 20 full implementation the 21-22 academic year yes ma'am great thank you mr gecker those are all of my

[00:41:23] questions okay dr duran first i want to thank you and the members of the commission for putting this work forward. I think it's so exciting to finally have us acknowledge, first of all, and second of all, actually put into some practice the notion that our history needs to be told for all and everyone's history needs to be told. So I'm very, very thankful for that and seeing this progress moving in that way. I wanted to follow, Dr. Wilson actually took the one question I had, so I'll just follow up a little bit on that in terms of the supports that will be put in place and the

[00:42:02] resources. Having said what I just said, most of the resources that we have in school divisions are not tailored or written or in any way close, actually contrary in some cases, telling a different story quite implicitly at times. So help me to understand what are some of the things that we might be able to do to help either encourage, I mean not encourage, but to help bring together more of those resources for school divisions or awareness of what those are.

[00:42:35] I understand that, you know, maybe providing them and we want to give each school division and we want to give our teachers the ability to choose from resources and things that are appropriate. But I do think we need to think of having some that are recommended because this is not an area that a lot of leaders and staff and teachers and know about where good resources are.

[00:42:56] This is a new developing form of acknowledgement, I would say, at least amongst the school systems as a large. So I think we're going to need more than just, here's the new curriculum, here's some guidance, here's some support, here's some direction.

[00:43:12] We're going to need to say, here are some good resources you should look into. And I don't, and I really encourage us to do that. And I would love to hear your thoughts on that. But because it's great that we're doing this, but I worry if we don't add that additional component to it, then it's gonna be for not because well-intended and school divisions are gonna want to implement this, but without the knowledge and the awareness to be able to shift towards this new history that needs to be taught, then I think that we will be potentially still struggling to ensure that all students, and this is for all students too.

[00:43:48] I read some comments and heard some feedback that was not very positive about why are we teaching African-American history to students who aren't African-American and why are we trying to change our history and tell people a whole different one? Well, this is for all students.

[00:44:03] This is not just for African-American students. African-American history is everyone's history. And that whole narrative and that thought process is what I'm worried about if we don't have some additional resources to provide. - Well, the first, we'll start with the recommendations from the commission.

[00:44:22] And we had that list in the presentation at the September 17th meeting. Another resource that we started with when we first started to develop the African-American history elective course in working with WHRO.

[00:44:41] And they've created about six or seven different playlists that are categorized by different content. And those items, I think they call them artifacts, within their playlist vary from full-blown lessons to videos that can span a couple of minutes to almost an hour. Some of them are lectures from different professors. It might be a lecture series

[00:45:16] or it might be a snippet from a documentary where it is appropriate from K-12. So that playlist is a really good recommendation as a matter of fact when they were putting it together they asked the department our staff if we could give them several topics to where they could take everything that had to do with african-american history within their catalog and kind of categorize them under those different topics and it just so happens that many of those topics are reflected in

[00:45:50] the changes that have been made to the curriculum frameworks. So we'll start there. We've spoken last week with the Virginia Museum of Fine Arts and they have offered to also curate some resources for us also that we can put into this chart. So we have a lot of different museums and organizations that are recommending and then we will go through those recommending recommendations to say this is what you really need to incorporate into your local curriculum

[00:46:30] or when you're teaching this particular content this is where you may want to have your teachers gain their background knowledge because like you said teachers may be unfamiliar with the content that we've added so we want to put something in place not just for their instruction but also for building their capacity their content capacity also that's going to be very important we also will need to reach out to um the media specialists in a sense that

[00:47:06] looking at what they have available in their library and media centers to support the changes that we have um in the curriculum frameworks and i don't know if christine or holly michael or dr lane would like to add to that don't everybody talk at once president gecker yes miss brown thank you very much for your thorough presentation and thank you colleagues for asking those questions and clarifying i am waiting to hear about the professional development piece for our teachers

[00:47:44] so that they can catch up to this full implementation by 2022. Can you elaborate a little bit more about that? Some of the professional development that we are considering and also doing, we've outlined, incorporated it into that projected timeline.

[00:48:05] Some of it will deal with cultural relevant practices. we are right now working with vcu for our teachers for african america for the african american history course and recording those sessions and making them available they'll be available on the doe website and also through go open it's very difficult i think for teachers right now with teaching virtually or in hybrid situations or even going back face to face to

[00:48:39] come out of that day and then join a live um session professional development session so we're trying to record as many of those as possible during the month of august we started a series of teaching hard history and we offered those sessions every thursday from 3 30 to 5 and um all of those sessions have been recorded and they are posted on our youtube channel also so that we

[00:49:14] can put those particular recordings into this chart to point teachers towards um helping them incorporate the the changes into their local curriculum and hopefully begin if no late if not earlier no later than the beginning of the new um school year so many of the much of the professional development that we're offering is live but it will also be recorded so that teachers when they have um time in their schedules they will be able to um attend or review those sessions

[00:49:54] so it's kind of twofold in a sense um where we're offering live sessions but also recording so that they can begin to expand their toolbox not only instructionally but also building their own background knowledge christine i was just going to add in the timeline we've added webinars that will begin in november and they're targeted by course as well as by educators from teachers to administrators to go over the changes in the curriculum framework so that we're targeting

[00:50:33] what they need by level so if it's for the kindergarten grade levels or the virginia studies as well as for administrators versus a teacher just going over those changes so that begins in november according to our timeline with the webinars and i also want to add that we have begun begun working with jean weller we have another advisory committee that will be starting in november was legislated by hb 916 and it specifically looks at culturally relevant and

[00:51:08] inclusive practices we received a lot of applications for that particular committee and many of them were teachers i want to say that probably about 40 40 to 50 percent of the applicants were teachers so we decided um in working with the equity office we decided to pull that group out as a teacher advisory committee because many of the applicants stressed their experience with culturally relevant teaching practices so we wanted to pull

[00:51:44] a group from that application pool to work as a cohort to develop resources and professional development we will start them at the same time that we start this committee but it will be a separate working group so that they can look at not just history and social science because a part of the legislation is that they review the standards but we wanted this particular group to think about culturally relevant teaching practices for not only our discipline but

[00:52:19] all disciplines leah did you want to add to that no just i was just going to add that um christania is doing so much work in this space that um she's probably not remembering every single detail of everything she's doing but um in addition to um what she's already mentioned that same group of teacher cohort that are um currently going through the pd we're offering related to the african-american elective course are also um charged and tasked with producing resource materials to support the successful um delivery of instruction uh for that course content and the

[00:52:56] way the um project's been designed much of the work that they're developing will be added in to go open and uh be provided to the broader field to support the successful instruction of these new um edits and the new content that's been added to the curriculum frameworks thank you totally forgot about them. Go ahead, Ann. I defer to Dr. Mann and then I would love to do that. Just really quickly, as I'm listening to the focus on professional development, it just came to me that

[00:53:37] maybe it would be interesting to think about how we're also going to be equipping and supporting leaders to deal more with the emotional side of what it means to teach this content. I think certainly the the information is is there and you're expecting that people are going to engage but i think we can't underestimate what it really means to truly uh confront dealing with uh telling history as it is when people have you know maybe are not going to be warm to that and so how do we

[00:54:09] create communities of support from a from a principal leadership or just trying to have a pulse on what schools are doing where they may be running into some challenge or resistance around incorporating, you know, the content.

[00:54:27] And I'm sure you all are thinking about that, but I just, from the angle of knowing what it really takes to do and live this work, the kind of support that is needed outside of just where's the content to help us teach is important.

[00:54:45] sure y'all are thinking about that but i just wanted to give an explicit call out to it because it is very different from you know the idea of what are the practices great we actually have something we're planning um specifically for school leaders and division level leaders for this fall that will focus um really intentionally around um culturally responsive pedagogy culture and climate around cultural responsiveness and cultural relevancy um in particular uh related

[00:55:19] to these new standards once our this new content once it is um approved by the board if it's successfully approved today and so we have a plan and a strategy for that for this fall where we'll be hosting a very large convening um for school level leaders and as well as division level leaders uh specifically related to that dr man great thank you leah it may also be good for you to talk about the ed equity webinar series that you have and the engagements that you do with equity leaders because we're identifying point people in every school division to lead equity and they will often be the person that can help with principals in their home communities one-on-one

[00:55:58] superintendents and Leah maybe talk a little bit about that sure thanks Dr. Lane uh so uh we have launched an what we call the ed equity VA webinar series where we are hosting um at a minimum about two webinars a month that are specifically focused on um different components of advancing equity outcomes in schools so we look we are focused on both culture climate um leadership principles what does it take to be a courageous leader um we've done some partnership work with vcu school of education where they're doing a lot of statewide leadership in this space particularly around the

[00:56:33] principles of anti-racism and education um settings and so those that webinar series uh we launched it in about we relaunched in february and we typically have over 500 registrants per session that we hold in around 300 participants for each session all of those um sessions are recorded and posted on our websites and we mail them out to everyone on our mailing list also so so that they can access that information and content at any time.

[00:57:05] We're looking at hosting a much larger convening, just again, honing in on some really specific topics that we know are of interest to the broader education stakeholder community. And then we also launched a community of practice with all of the local equity leads across the state.

[00:57:24] We meet with them every two weeks in a virtual setting. And then we also have created a digital platform community of practice where they could exchange ideas and practices and start working in more regional ways on issues that are presenting themselves, you know, that are specific to a region.

[00:57:42] So we definitely have the infrastructure in place to support I think really intentional professional development and professional learning opportunities around this topic and some of our much broader equity topics that we're focusing on as an agency.

[00:57:59] then we are also having our conversation with um uva center for a public education and race in the race and public education in the south uh and they are gearing up to actually um be positioned to provide uh um they're calling it um continuing education units or something like that specifically related to um being able to adequately teach african-american history content based on the recommendations that were put forward by the african-american history education commission

[00:58:33] so they're already gearing up to um have a pd in place for teachers who are seeking more information on the actual content to increase their knowledge base great and i think uh leah's comment really is a good reminder that whereas we're talking a lot about the professional development we're doing right now to be responsive to the potential vote that you're going to take there is a whole long-term strategy if you recall from the commission's work to uh revise

[00:59:06] professional development in a broader way around this area and so there were there whereas you're focusing on the standard recommendations there will be a future date where we'll come back whether that comes from the general assembly or directly to the board uh will remain to be seen but where we'll actually handle their uh professional development recommendations for the long term as well which are a really important piece of their work that is complementary to the standards review that you're doing today. Thank you. Dalton, did you still have a comment? Yes,

[00:59:41] thank you. Looking at the timeline, you know, I know our the process for our regular process for reviewing the standards and framework is a complex and involved and long one, I see, with work beginning already but being finalized late in 22 i believe i understand the timeline correctly that the matter is not formally brought back before the board until the summer of 22 for when the standards are brought the new draft of the standards and correct on framework are brought to

[01:00:20] us for first review and that's probably what we typically do but i i will say that my experience is i sometimes feel like we're brought into the loop fairly late in the game and if there could be an opportunity and and i know that's because there's a lot of work that needs to be done before you've got product to share with us but if we could be brought up to speed uh sometime in 21 and and have the opportunity to engage and offer our feedback as the process goes forward before you bring an actual document to us for first review that might be helpful to us all okay it

[01:00:58] might be helpful to the final approval okay well um we're officially bringing a timeline um to you and i believe in a report in january so what we can do is go back through the um timeline that's presented and projected timeline that's presented in attachment e and look for some space um to do just that thank you okay let me ask one last question uh as you go through the sol review is

[01:01:33] that the standards review do you also do a parallel review of the framework this projected timeline um will put them side by side so that we have one document instead of two um previously in the past review for the 2015 standards we did we went through the whole process just for the standards and then made adjustments to the curriculum framework so that the state the curriculum

[01:02:05] framework document aligned to the standards what is being proposed in attachment e is that that takes place simultaneously so that there's not an adjustment a year later for the curriculum

framework but as we're developing the standards that we develop curriculum framework content at the same time so the curriculum framework can be harmonized to the standards as you go through yes mr gecker this is probably a good time for me to interject a second um and the one of the

[01:02:42] things that i have found at the department and this is uh this is a much longer conversation that we hope to have with the board in a future month but i think it will answer your question One of the things that I have found is that when our standards are reviewed by national conglomerates and other entities, our standards are often found to be lacking in some content.

[01:03:04] And then our response is generally, well, if you look in the framework, we address it in the framework. And you can't just look at our standards alone. You have to look at the standards and the framework. We've been having a lot of conversation as a team, and we think that the history standards review will be a process that we will bring to you as we go through this timeline.

[01:03:24] But our thinking right now is to not have separate standards and frameworks anymore, and just to incorporate the frameworks into the standards so it's one big set. You know, it used to be that the board adopted the standards, the department did frameworks, but we described to you last month that really the board set a precedent that you do the frameworks as well.

[01:03:43] And so our thinking is that we will not have separate documents that, you know, it's a lot to ask someone besides a teacher, but a parent, a citizen, to look at our standards and then go look at some other documents. We really want to know what we're teaching. We really feel like it's more transparent to have it all in one place.

[01:04:02] We're going to ask you for permission to do that later, but I think that will partly address your concern that we'll have two separate processes where really we think we need in all standard areas one set of documents. so that when anyone reviews our standards, they see everything that kids are learning in our classrooms.

[01:04:19] - Actually, that was not my concern, James. It was, I guess, couple-fold. We're revising the framework, which is fine, which is sort of the more detailed version of what we're teaching.

[01:04:37] However, and we're doing that on a fairly quick basis, right? I mean, it's the timeline from proposal to adoption going to be pretty short relative to what it's been in the past. Then we're going to go through at the standards next year where the department is and I want to but in the meantime we're going to be developing all this material for the field and what if as you go through the standards the

[01:05:13] framework basically changes some and we've done a lot of work this year or now that is going to be rendered you know just incorrect or not appropriate or wrong words being used here but not in concert with whatever we come up with next year it is we want to teach and you know i understand and i'm actually uh approve of the desire to move the framework changes through uh now but i guess and again this is probably just an example of somebody outside the field not understanding exactly how

[01:05:52] the pieces fit together but it seems to me that the new pd around you know or a significant amount of work today around a framework that might actually change some uh is wasteful is the wrong word because i don't think this is a waste but it is concerning to me in terms of process and just want some comfort that we believe that what we're doing today is not going to be changed as as you go through the standards review with a more full process, which is one of the reasons, honestly, I asked about,

[01:06:30] had we reviewed, had the department had a chance to review all the public comment, the specific comments made with regard to factual issues that are being put forward today. You know, I just don't wanna see it done and then undone.

[01:06:47] Dr. Bolson. - So yeah, Mr. Gecker, thank you. said a different way from my vantage point is and it's the paradigm i think that perhaps i have operated many of us have operated under that the standards drive the framework whereas in this process it could feel like the framework will drive the standards and so to be very clear about And James, Dr. Lane, I appreciate the idea that incorporating the two together is likely where we want to head, but thinking about what is driving what,

[01:07:26] what's the lead, right? And so as the, for me, as the standards are being reviewed, being open, I suppose, that the framework itself, though we may approve revisions today, that there may be further revision to the revision based on so just being very much open to a full process that will allow for the best set of documents, whatever we call them and whatever is contained in them so that our students will learn the fullest or be exposed to the fullest history that they can

[01:08:05] and that our teachers, our leaders have the resources available to them. So Mr. Gecker, I concur with your concern would frame for me that the frame that i've just described is how i've been thinking about it i appreciate your translating for me it's uh yeah and and i take it that we're also at this point even though we're gonna put this in the framework the assessments will not change so uh yeah the the assessments will not change uh until the 2022 revision because we've uh we've

[01:08:43] already developed the the 2015 assessments uh the and then i just want mr garrick you've asked this a couple times so i just want to make sure i said it plainly yes the department reviewed all of the public comment i i read it myself i considered it and it didn't change my recommendation though it does inform me as i think forward to the main standards revision in 22 and and i would also say i would guarantee that there will be some changes between what you do now in 2022 because

[01:09:11] There are certainly recommendations that we're asking you to consider later, but there's also, and we've talked to you some about this in the past, a movement to a more thematic history than only a chronological history, and I think that that will bring another level of depth that will be really appreciated.

[01:09:28] So I see this as a step to where we want to go rather than a diversion to where we want to go. It's clearly on the pathway, but I think we'll continue to develop the standards to make them even better in 2022. And I believe that any work we do now will be beneficial in the 2022 revision.

[01:09:45] Thank you, Jen, by the way, and I appreciate the direct answer to the question. And I'll just chime in to say it is a dilemma whether to go fast or to go carefully, but recognizing that our normal process even expedited by combining the curriculum framework and standard review it is a two-year process so starting now those changes won't be finalized until late 22 and then won't really be available and implemented in the schools until the following school year so we're talking three years from now and and i agree with the

[01:10:23] sense of urgency from the commission and i know you all do too that for instance something like lynching being missing from the standards um you know that there's three years is too long to wait uh three sets three years worth of students coming through the system i think it is appropriate to do what we can on a more urgent basis now um even if that does disrupt the normal process and and President Gecker, on that point Ms. Holtman made, I just wanted to say, as Dr. Lane, I listened to

[01:11:01] you talk about the process and the opportunity to combine, and I guess what this moment makes me think about is that, you know, whatever process is reimagined, there needs to always be space for change that we can't predict or know what's going to happen in any dimension of how we think about what it means to for children to be educated and so i i think it's important to ensure that if frameworks are brought together with curriculum with the standards that it doesn't uh get in

[01:11:40] the way when you consider you know there could be a 10-year process where you're living with the reality of seven years living with the reality of standards that a moment in history may turn on its end, and I feel like there has to be incorporated in how this gets reimagined an opportunity for that to be honored, right? And so I just wanted to share that because these are massive undertakings, and when they're in place, they're in place for a significant period given

[01:12:17] everything that flows into them from assessments and so forth, but a process must not be so rigid and fix that we can't intervene if history requires it. I want to make clear that was not my suggestion.

[01:12:36] No, but I wanted to say out loud, that's what I, you know, appreciating the desire to make things efficient and come together so it's not so overwhelming. It is a lot for people to digest and appreciate how these things all work together. But I do perceive that this standalone opportunity with a framework allows you some flexibility to make edits and deal with change that doesn't disrupt your process on standards, if that needs to be fixed and set.

[01:13:09] I will say I have no problem with the content. I have, and again, this is probably my lack of experience in the education industry. I am constantly concerned about how what we do here gets translated into the field.

[01:13:25] You know, my goal, and I think the board's goal, is to educate our children in the best way possible. And what that means is, in part, giving clear guidance to those people who are teaching our children, you know, what is supposed to happen in the classroom. And so, you know, I worry a little bit, again, not about this content, but about a process that allows for rapid shifts in our expectations in the field.

[01:13:55] I mean, because as aware as we may be of the need to make changes in what we have, what we do is only as good as how it gets communicated in the classroom, right? We're not doing this for the adults, we're doing this for the kids.

[01:14:10] This is not about, frankly, responding positively or negatively to the African American History Education Commission or the politicians who write to us. This is about how do we translate we believe ought to be taught in our schools into the classroom so that our children get the best education possible and the education we believe they ought to have and so when i ask questions about process it is really uh completely divorced from the content it is really geared to you know helping me understand better what the impact of our action is on the product we're looking to

[01:14:50] produce which is you know educated children and so uh the comments ought not be read any other way than that and I will honestly say I still have uh you know some concerns about how this plays in the field which I don't think is any different from the concerns that have been expressed by the professional education community but again it is not a concern over content and the process is only as good as again what it translates to you know do we achieve the result we're looking to achieve

[01:15:26] And, you know, I'm hopeful after having listened to James and Christiana that, you know, we will figure out a way to have, and to Leah, you know, figure out a way to have this translated appropriately into the classroom. You know, for us to do stuff on our own is meaningless to me, unless, again, it changes classroom behavior and kid outcome. Anyway, Dr. Duran.

[01:15:56] I thank you for those comments and I from further clarification and I just want to add I think that in this case too there are actions that we take that cannot be divorced from what the field is and the shift that would occur but in this case I think are the actions of having a curriculum on history and social studies overall that does not acknowledge a group of students and their own history also sends a message to those in the field to not teach and sometimes and I'll be frank I've heard many people use that as an excuse well it's not in the standards it's not in the framework it's

[01:16:35] not and so I don't need to teach that you're asking me to do something that's not even required by the DOE or by the state I've heard that many times um and so fine superintendents like you Francisco, who make the teachers and the principals do what it is they're supposed to do.

[01:16:53] Right, but I think from the board level, from our responsibility we have as state board members, is to really be thoughtful, to your point, and to not do things in absence because we think or feel it's the best thing or it's the latest comment we've received. But we also have to ground that in the reality of when we see and when we know that students are not being taught and recognized in their own lessons, they're not being valued, they're not seeing themselves in the curriculum. And when we see that, then there are going to be some major shifts that we need to put

[01:17:29] in place. And the question that many of us are asking that you were also, the professional development, the resources, we can't just tell teachers in school divisions, this is not happening, needs to happen period no that's why i asked about what resources can we put in place and dr wilson about supporting teachers document several of us because that concern and you i'm sure have that same exact concern about just mandating or dictating something from here that we think is best um to do or the right thing to do even sometimes the right thing to do isn't what you have the way you do the right thing isn't always the right way right so we have to be

[01:18:05] thoughtful about about that but for me this is an area where i think we all have to make that shift quickly as possible with full support because too many students are not seeing themselves in the curriculum and then too many other students are as a result of that defining and stereotyping and stigmatizing our african-american students in a way that doesn't value and honor them and their contributions to our history and so i appreciated hearing what you say because i do reminds me and it should remind all of us we need to be thoughtful about how we proceed with things and we need to

[01:18:43] be mindful of that but i also want to just balance that with all of us remembering that we have to think about what our students are experiencing i'm not saying you weren't but i'm saying that overall as we go through major changes like this that has to be a forefront at least for me i lead with how is how are our students experiencing their education are they really receiving one that really values them and i do believe that not being included in the curriculum is a message to them that they're not valued i actually i concur with that francisco i think that's exactly right it is a message you know i spent uh you know rarely talk about personal

[01:19:20] things i spent yesterday in traffic court with one of my daughters uh and you know there were out of all the defendants there were two white defendants and you know my you know daughter looked at

me and said you know looked around the room and said this is the problem and it's no different in our schools in the same way you know it is clear that we have got to do something different so no i live it every day francisco in any event uh cristania any further words of wisdom before we take this to a vote?

[01:19:58] - I have nine. - Yeah, well, I appreciate your patience. - Thank you for all of your comments. I really appreciate that. We really appreciate that. - Okay, is there a motion on item H to approve, I guess it's attachment A first, as changes to the curriculum framework?

[01:20:20] - So moved, President Gecker. - Thank you, Dr. Wilson, is there a second? - Second. - Thank you, Dr. Duran. I don't see any further discussion, so we'll do a roll call vote, Ms. Holton. Aye. Ms. Davis-Vaught. Aye.

[01:20:38] Dr. Duran. Aye. Dr. Wilson. Aye. And Dr. Mann. Aye. And I vote aye. And then, is there a motion, we did not discuss this at length, but I think we've covered the topic, for attachment D, which would be the additional standards.

[01:21:00] Do I have this right, Kristina? The additional substandard, yes, sir. Substandard, excuse me. actually I'm looking at the title it says standard for consideration but I'll revise it in my mind to substandard okay all right is there a motion to adopt essentially the substandard just sounds wrong to say on attachment D so moved thank you Dr. Duran is there a second second okay thank you miss Davis fought

[01:21:31] again by roll call. Ms. Holtan? Aye. Ms. Davis-Faught? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. And I vote aye. Okay. Thank you very much, everybody who participated in that discussion. Thank you. All right, item aye. Thank you, Krystania. Item aye. Sorry, Mr. Geck, I just had to say a special thank you to Krystania. She's worked so hard on this, and I just congrats, Krystania, on wrapping that. I've been heading to the harder work, which is the

[01:22:08] next phase and and Leah and everyone in the Commission members I'm sorry I just had to thank you yes yay thank you all right have a great afternoon Cristania let me celebrate you then once from the chair congratulations this has been awesome the next person who hijacks my beating however Emily please mute them thanks Dr. Gecker have a good one thank you all right item I final review of a process to certify a list of qualified persons for the office of division superintendents of schools

[01:22:44] miss pitts good morning president gecker members of the board and dr lane it is a pleasure for me this morning to present this item to you at your last meeting we went over this matter in detail but i will quickly recap the constitution of virginia requires the board of education to certify to the school board of each division a list of qualified persons for the office of division superintendent of schools prior to 1993 virginia did not issue a division superintendent

[01:23:19] license during prior to that time a list of individuals who were eligible for appointment were was presented to the board of education each month in 1993 however a division superintendent license was established and no longer was a list of eligible individuals sent to the board of education for certification in order to meet this constitutional requirement however

[01:23:53] the following procedure is proposed for you today initially the board will certify a list of the names of the individuals who currently hold a division superintendent license so you will receive the entire list. Subsequently, new applications will be reviewed to ensure that they meet the Board of Education requirements, and the names of those individuals will be presented to the Board of Education for certification. And upon board certification,

[01:24:27] then the division superintendent license would be issued. During the last meeting, you asked that I reach out to the Virginia School Boards Association to inquire how this new process may impact its work in assisting school boards to appoint superintendents.

[01:24:46] I talked to the Executive Director, Gina Patterson, and she conveyed to me two concerns. The first, which is her primary concern, is timing. The Board of Education does not meet every month. In our current environment, when a school board, sometimes an individual, or a search company communicates with me that a school board is making a decision and needs the person to have

[01:25:20] the division superintendent license we accommodate that schedule it's not unusual for me to receive the credentials overnight process them that day issue the division superintendent license so a school board can make its announcement within the next day or a matter of a week that is really not uncommon for us so she's very concerned about that timing issue as well as the issue of confidentiality

[01:25:53] but let me explain all of you know that if one has a division superintendent license or any license that's public information we have a public query on our webpage that one can put in a name and see whether someone has been issued a license her concern which is certainly less than the timing issue, but one that may be expressed by applicants is that both out-of-state and in-state applicants

[01:26:23] sometimes wait until they are in the final candidate pool before they apply for the division's superintendent license or until they've been selected. Her concern, and again it is less than the timing, is that when individuals apply and their names are submitted to the board, those names are more prominent, so it could prompt more questions from employers. For example,

[01:26:56] if I was applying for a division superintendency and my name was on this list for certification, there could be questions from a current employer, "Oh, are you applying for other employment?" But again, the basic and the major concern that she has is with the full-timing issue and that it could take up to two or three months before a school board could appoint the candidate of its

[01:27:29] choice because the individual's name must be certified by the board, but we certainly understand to the constitutional duty of the Board of Education. And as such, the Superintendent of public construction recommends that the board of education approve the process to certify a list of qualified persons for the office of division superintendent of schools and i'll be happy to answer any questions you may have there any questions from board members miss holton uh so uh

[01:28:05] thank you miss pittsford for uh sharing the what we're trying to do and the concerns uh and i had a brief conversation with Dr. Lane about this as well earlier this morning. I am concerned about the VSBA objections, and we also did get a letter from the VSBA in the public comment that came in last night that reiterated the same two positions that you raised today. If I understand it correctly, this is a system that basically is working, but we're trying to make sure we are complying with

[01:28:43] the legal require the constitutional legal requirement that's the instigation for change here i guess i just i don't know what the legal fix is but i have enough faith in good lawyering that i'm convinced we ought to be able to find a solution that meets the constitutional legal requirement without um setting us back on us on a process that's basically working for helping school boards find their next superintendents i don't want the board to give up its authority

[01:29:17] over this because there may be occasions when we need to exercise it but um but i'm just worried that you know that we haven't yet come up with a solution that answers the two objections you

raised and it's hard to find good superintendents these days this is one of the toughest it is the toughest job in education i'm convinced it's not surprising that we have rapid turnover it's not surprising that it's hard for school boards to hire good superintendents and i just hate to put any extra obstacles in the way so my question is is it worth taking a little more time to try to work with

[01:29:56] lawyers and the school board association and maybe bring in the superintendents association and see if that you know leave no stone unturned to find a solution that satisfies the constitutional requirement but doesn't uh but that also somehow addresses these concerns and you know i i don't know what the solution is i'm just wondering have we turned over all the stones and this is the best we can do or is it worth taking a little more time and see if we can improve upon it miss holton we

[01:30:29] did look at alternatives such as whether it would be possible for the board to by resolution to give that authority to dr lane as the superintendent of public instruction however we did consult with council and that did not seem to be a viable avenue and certainly if susan williams wants to add to this answer it may be more appropriate coming from her hi this is susan williams

[01:31:01] yes uh we did uh look at um every stone um and it's because it is a constitutional authority and responsibility of the board of education it's not something that can be delegated um to dr lane or to the department of education um i mean you know there were other alternatives that we did consider um and and patty you probably better want to discuss the pros and cons of these but you know under the current system if you continue to issue a superintendent's license

[01:31:36] and then have it ratified later by the board but that that has some problems too um and so susan may i ask can i ask the process question have you had the opportunity to sit down with bass and or vsba and just brainstorm is there a way i mean get your creativity juices going that's what we look good lawyers do, right? And figure out a way that meets their needs, but also meets our constitutional obligations. And then maybe you all have done that already and we've come up with the

[01:32:11] best we can do. I have not brainstormed with the associations, no. And I don't think they have, I don't know if they have access to legal counsel, but I just wonder whether it's worth taking a little more time. Dr. Duran has been through this process recently. I think I see him waving.

[01:32:34] Well, I was just going to say this, I wanted to echo your comments, Ms. Holton, and see if there was, well, first of all, to understand, I think you remember I brought this up at the last time in the first review about the concern of the timing. So I did want to understand if we had gone through all potential options completely and this literally was the only one, or if not, there were other ways to pause on this and look a little further before we had to approve this.

[01:33:00] So you did answer my, you did ask my questions. I still, maybe Susan would like to hear a little more clarity. Do you think there's an opportunity to go and look at this one more time with some associations, et cetera? Or is this feel uncomfortable at this time trying to move forward without knowing that for sure? And I get that it's a constitutional requirement. So I understand that, but I don't feel too comfortable moving forward as one board member on this because of all the complexities and that I know it will cause if there's no other choice and you're saying there's no other choice and it's required. That's one thing, but I would love to hear from

[01:33:39] you, Susan, that that's the case, or if not, that there could be some more consideration. I have certainly looked into this in great detail, but like I said, I mean, the only other choice that we came up with

that was discussed was that the continue the process that the department does right now so patty you know issues the um superintendent's license um the only problem with that is that you know it would have to be the you know after the you kind of be doing things in reverse order i'm not saying you can't do that i'm just saying that it would be a matter of patty issuing the license and then the next board meeting that person's name would be on the list

[01:34:18] um the problem there would be if somebody and i can't i cannot even give you a hypothetical that would that would um you know be likely but the only problem with that approach would be if the person was issued a superintendent's license got a job based on it or got the promise of a job i should say based on it and then the board at the next meeting didn't include along the list of eligibles then the school division wouldn't be able to hire them and i would ask patty to speak up you know some of the because we have been back and forth through this some of the process part

[01:34:51] because some of this is process and not a legal issue. Right. I do have concerns about issuing a division superintendent license that then has to be certified by the board. Once a person has a license, one thinks he or she can do what that license prescribes it to do. For example, be appointed as a division superintendent. Once you have a teaching license, you can teach. Once you have a driver's license, you can drive. I think that giving someone a license and then having it

[01:35:26] certified, they still need to wait until the certification has been completed to be appointed a division superintendent. So we found that process to be complicated and confusing, whereas what we are proposing would be more straightforward. And, you know, as we said, we have really discussed this process certainly can discuss it again with the association and

[01:35:57] its attorney but the proposal that we have before you today appears to be at this point the best solution but again if you wish us if you want us to go back to the association and and it does have its own attorney then we can certainly do that thank you um patty and susan i i as one board member i would like that but i don't hear from my colleagues to see what they how they feel but as one person i would feel more comfortable with that dr wilson thank you um patty one thing you just

[01:36:37] said uh the the complexity or the added layer or perhaps confusion on issuing a license before certification by the board is that process feels a lot like what local school divisions do for example when they issue a contract or make an offer to a teacher you know outside of the process of their local boards meeting and you mean the language i think says something like contingent upon approval by the local board so i'm not certain if if there are different complexities in this scenario that we're talking about with division superintendents compared to what happens

[01:37:15] at a local level can you help me understand the difference there I think the difference is that if a school board is negotiating with an individual who it wishes to employ or appoint I think at that point there they do have conversations even now to say that we are very interested in appointing you as superintendent however you do not have a division superintendent license once you receive that then the appointment can be made so i think that's pretty analogous to a school division they

[01:37:51] might even give them a letter saying that you are the candidate of choice if these particular criteria have been met but the concern is that if we actually issue the license itself i think it because since 1993 that's what we've been doing and once you have that you are on what we call an eligible list of division superintendents which we're required by statute to maintain we issue that list to school boards that are interested in employing individuals on you know it's a public

[01:38:27] list if it's requested i do think that it becomes more problematic if we give that license and what if an individual takes that license and goes to another state another state issues that person a division superintendent license based upon our license and it really hasn't been vetted or certified as stated in the constitution, I do think that could be problematic for individuals.

[01:38:57] We don't want someone to move from one job to another on the basis of having a division superintendent license that has not gone through the full process to be certified. Again, I guess, Pat, I distinguish in my mind between having the qualifications to be a superintendent, which is what the license does, and being eligible to be hired.

[01:39:23] You know, we gave teacher's licenses to people who had, you know, felonies, and then we had a statute that said, you know, school division couldn't hire them. But that didn't make them any less having a teacher's license, right? All this. So I'm not sure about the confusion piece either. I mean, we made it through those times.

[01:39:44] I mean, why wouldn't the license just indicate meeting the base criteria to be a superintendent? I mean, and again, remembering the history of this provision, it was the change from the state appointing all division superintendents to having the locals essentially being picked from a list approved by the board.

[01:40:09] Whereas, again, they can have the, I'm missing the harm of having the superintendent's license and being able to go elsewhere and say, I have a superintendent's license. I will say, even from our experience with individuals who hold licenses who have felony convictions, who have been limited on employment opportunities based upon that felony conviction, It has caused confusion with school divisions about those people's employability because they have the license.

[01:40:48] Certainly we could do more education. We could make things clearer. I'm not saying it couldn't be done, but I would say that it is not as straightforward as once you receive a license, then you're eligible to serve in that particular position But certainly we can review this again and come back to the board with another look, after another look.

[01:41:21] President Gecker, I mean, as I listen to this, it makes me sort of wonder, and you started to talk about historically why we're here. And, you know, I listen to this because if you get a license, you should be able to do the job. and the certification. I do understand that the board is charged with sort of protecting the integrity of public education in the Commonwealth, but this feels like one of those moments where there is an added step that creates complexity that I don't really understand because in the

[01:41:54] world of private employment, the idea of people being able to confidentially pursue things, it's just it feels very not in keeping with securing the best talent if you will in ways that i just it feels like a an element of bureaucracy that is controlling more than i i just and i know we don't change the constitution every day and i know we can't like put that up as like let's go for the constitution today to deal with the problem but it it feels like one of those

[01:42:29] moments as i'm trying to parse out why are we doing it in this way if we want to operate in ways that positions the commonwealth to secure the best possible talent for these very challenging jobs i just i'm struggling let me talk about it from a different way then uh because what we have effectively done since the 90s i guess it is when we started doing you know superintendents licenses is we delegated effectively our responsibility under the constitution to staff and so it's not

[01:43:08] that now nobody is checking for our people qualified to do it to protect it it's that now staff is doing it exclusively instead of the board doing it and we had the circumstance fairly recently uh james was involved with where a division wanted to hire somebody locally uh who didn't meet the criteria and essentially it was staff who ended up making that call instead of the board so we're not actually adding a layer of bureaucracy in a sense what we're doing is we're

[01:43:41] saying that this is a responsibility we are not entitled to delegate fully and in fact here what we're saying is because i cannot imagine a circumstance where we would take the work of staff look underneath it and say if staff recommends or says this person has got the requisite qualifications, the board, I just can't imagine a circumstance where we would say no, they don't. That's just not going to happen. But on the other hand, it is a non-delegable duty that

[01:44:15] we have. And in this era of originalist constitutional interpretation that we're going to go through soon. You know, we don't have an option. I mean, it could be argued that every superintendent out there today who has not gone through board certification could not have been hired legally by these divisions. As crazy as that seems, I mean, we veered away from a process that, you know, because I guess pre-division or superintendent licenses, the board was doing it, right?

[01:44:45] Correct. We veered away and maybe we shouldn't have, but I'm happy to defer this item to see if there is a different fix that impacts timing I am you know but I don't see how we legitimately now can say this is not a board responsibility I mean it's an express mandate well that's helpful I appreciate that I didn't have the history on how we got there but I still I mean there's a piece of me when you think about the frequency of when the board meets all of the board responsibilities

[01:45:24] whether that belongs here and if there is a and i know it's the constitution right now we have to do but i know i will say the frequency argument does not sit with me as well honestly as the confidentiality argument because on the frequency piece uh you know superintendent searches go on for periods of months you know we don't see them doing it in in four weeks in three weeks you know there's a process that people go through that it's inconceivable to me that we wouldn't have during the course of that process a meeting at which somebody could be uh approved on that list

[01:46:01] i i just don't see that as realistic even you know the divisions we've been involved with recently you know we had knowledge of the candidates you know some some of the candidates uh you know with regard to the divisions under mou you know where we've been involved in that some we know and i I mean, the bigger issue to me is you have folks from out of state, for example, who would not normally have a Virginia license.

[01:46:30] And we've had, James, has that all been announced yet down? I mean, we can talk about this. Have they been hired yet, the last MOU? That is not official. Okay.

[01:46:45] So forget that one. But we can talk about Petersburg, right, where Dr. Petrie-Martin came from outside the state. she would have been much more disadvantaged not by the timing issue but by the confidentiality because we you know she was in that process for a period of time which would have crossed over with a board meeting but in order to have been on the list she would have had to specifically come up to virginia and say put me on the list vet my qualifications and uh you know approve me that to me is much more problematic than the timing i think the timing's a little bit of a

[01:47:23] red herring, honestly, given what I've seen of how long it takes to hire a superintendent. And that goes to your point, by the way, Dr. Mann, of in the modern workplace, confidential movement, I think that's exactly right. If I may, but you're absolutely right.

[01:47:42] It's the confidentiality, but how the confidentiality intersects with the timing issue. And so that I get back to the let's get let's get our creative juices flowing and see if the vast and vsba folks and patty and and susan can together come up with something that you know maybe we have maybe there's things we can do an executive session or maybe we can have emergency meetings as needed it's not going to happen a lot i don't think you know many candidates will be already on the list many candidates will be confidentiality won't be such a concern so they

[01:48:21] can put in in the regular course or divisions may be comfortable hiring people announcing a hiring subject to the approval uh uh the the the later approval uh uh of the person's qualifications by the board you know so i i i think the cases where it's actually going to come i i i i wonder i don't know whether the cases where it's actually going to come to a real question would be few and far between but anyway i i come back to that i don't know that we can solve it here but i i think that

[01:48:55] we we ought we ought to put it off and get our uh charge our our our team to go back to the drawing board and see if they can come up with some creative alternatives i would second the motion if you're making one yeah no motion i think we'll just defer this uh until okay the next meeting but thank you Francisco uh and Susan if you don't mind coordinating with Patty or Patty if you don't mind coordinating with Susan uh let's get the vast people involved and perhaps you know the school

[01:49:29] board folks and see if there's a a process that they would prefer that still does not you know that meets the constitutional test here be glad to work thank you okay thank you all right item j uh final review of proposed revisions to the regulations governing educational services uh for gifted students all right good afternoon uh well actually it's still morning it's almost afternoon president gecker dr lane dr wilson and members of the board of education it's my pleasure

[01:50:08] to present to you the proposed changes for the uh to the regulations governing the gift uh education of the gifted for final review. I'm going to share my screen now. Let's see what we got here.

[01:50:25] All right. Can you all see the screen? Yes, we can. Thank you. During the discussion in September, the board requested that further revisions to the regulations, number one, require that the local gifted plan address their goals, objectives, and strategies to address underrepresentation of student groups and require that the local gifted plan address their efforts to support the diversity

[01:51:01] goals of their academic year governor school if a participating member. These changes were included in red and with double underlining on page 11 of the board item. In addition, the board asked the VDOE to increase the transparency regarding the identification of gifted students. Since that time we have initiated the process of adding gifted identification by race ethnicity gender

[01:51:35] and socioeconomics to each school's school quality profile the board also requested that we consider changes to the gifted annual report to include achievement measures that monitor underrepresentation and underachievement these changes will include further tracking of diploma achievement achievement on national and international assessments and by requesting additional data on numbers of gifted

[01:52:09] referrals and gifted identification and highlighting underrepresented populations finally the board requested a list of those individuals involved in the review and revision of the gifted regulations that listing is included in your board book thank you uh and i'd be happy to take any kind of questions and then subsequently the superintendent of public construction would recommend that the board of education accept the proposed regulations for final review okay well thank you are there any

[01:52:46] questions i guess none uh okay so president gecker i'm sorry not a question not a question but a comment um to mr boland and um dr poland thank you very much for incorporating those the suggestions and the changes we requested um particularly around uh aligning to goals the annual plan the gifted annual plan

[01:53:22] aligning to local goals as well as this idea of accountability and how we seek to to hold divisions and localities accountable to to this what we see i well what i see as a clear step toward equity or making opportunities available to all of our students so appreciate that response indeed i'm very thankful that you all did this i guess i recently saw the guess the data michael that you may have put together with regard to identification among

[01:54:00] the various groups and you know it's sort of i wouldn't say shocking because you knew it was there but it is it's stark to see it out uh you know in black and white on the screen just how you know off it is in terms of percentage of population versus percentage identified as gifted in the various divisions of course i would note if you live in northern virginia your chances are about one in four of being gifted so uh based on the data that i saw so it may be time to just move our kids up there and improve our odds uh if you've looked at the

[01:54:37] data you know what i'm talking about it is the percentage of people tagged gifted in various divisions varies widely and uh northern virginia seems to uh as a general rule tag more gifted than most of the rest of the commonwealth all right uh president gecker pardon me for interrupting again that's all right you may uh mute her if you want go ahead dr wilson i'll mute myself in just a second um but just to acknowledge that we had a fair amount of uh public comment uh around uh

[01:55:14] this item and or tangentially comments around identify or practices around admissions in the northern virginia area so i do want to acknowledge that there was a lot of comment in our for the board in this month there was now i'm going on mute no that's not right uh although with regard to the admissions in particular that has been or is being handled as a local matter i think in fairfax as i understand the way that's going uh although i did see that my home county just

[01:55:50] recently adopted new rules uh in terms of sending uh you know how to identify candidates for maggie walker which i certainly appreciate in any event is there a motion uh to adopt these item j moved thank you is there a second second thank you dr duran okay by roll call miss holton hi miss davis

[01:56:17] Ms. Paul? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. And I vote aye. Okay, moving on. Item K, final review of the edition of state-approved textbooks for K-12 science. Ms. Peterson?

[01:56:37] Hey, good morning, Mr. Gecker, members of the board, and Dr. Lane. I am here today to present a revision to the state-approved textbooks looks for K-12 science. As you know, it is the responsibility of the Board of Education to approve textbooks for use in Virginia public schools.

[01:56:55] These approved textbooks align to the state's academic standards and are one resource that divisions may use when providing science instruction. On September 17, 2020, the Board approved the

state-approved textbooks for K-12 science, with the exception of one textbook, and that textbook was Virginia Elevate Science, Grade 6.

[01:57:16] This text was not approved due to a lack of diversity that was ascertained through an additional equity review of the proposed textbooks. This additional review was done at the request of the board during the July 23, 2020 meeting. Since the proposed textbook was reviewed by textbook review teams and was found to align to the 2018 sciences standards of learning, the publisher was allowed to update the images to reflect a greater level of diversity.

[01:57:45] Once the images were updated, the publishers resubmitted the text for inclusion on the State of Port-approved textbooks for K-12 science. The updated images were reviewed by the VDOE science team and shared with board members, and it was determined that these revised images reflect a higher level of diversity, thus allowing students the opportunity to see themselves, their community, and their culture within the text.

[01:58:13] Our next steps are to provide professional development on how to use textbooks, as well as other resources in the development and implementation of quality science instruction. The quest for equitable science instruction for all students of Virginia must continue to be emphasized in all of our work moving forward.

[01:58:32] I'd like to thank you all for your courteous attention and consideration, and the Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board receive for final review the attached revised list of textbooks for K through 12 science. I would be happy to answer any questions at this time.

[01:58:50] First, let me say sorry about Ms. Peterson, it's Dr. Peterson. It is difficult for me sometimes to remember who is doctor and who is not. So are there any questions or comments here?

[01:59:06] Ms. Holtis? - Yes, I'd first just like to thank Dr. Peterson and colleagues for helping us get this right. And the publisher has in fact made good changes, I think to this book. They didn't add a lot of pictures, but there aren't a whole lot of pictures of people in the book to start with.

[01:59:24] And the changes that they made do, I think, allow students to see of all backgrounds and demographics to see themselves as scientists. Particularly, they've got a sort of career options, part of the textbook series.

[01:59:44] And so I think the changes in this are good. My only regret, frankly, is that, well, or the lesson learned is that these publishers will respond to our concerns. And this was the book we identified as the worst offender. There were others that we might've wanted to nudge, but focused only on the worst offender.

[02:00:04] And so I think the lesson for the future is we should feel free to speak up and share our concerns because the publishers can and will be responsive to those concerns. And then the other lesson is that when I know that Dr. Peterson and team are working on this, though maybe this is a more department wide effort, we do need to remember to revise our textbook criteria to make sure that this equity piece is part of what we get from in the first place.

[02:00:33] So I am supportive of these changes. I don't actually have a question. I'm just thanking you, Dr. Peterson, and thanking the publisher for making changes. And I would be supportive of approving, adding this textbook to the list that we approved last month now.

[02:00:49] - Okay, any other comments, Dr. Wilson? - Just a brief comment to acknowledge that I appreciate the written report in our materials, which get to high quality instructional materials where I see there is a mention here of equity and cultural relevance, which I think gets to Ms. Holden's point just a bit ago about this particular, this science textbooks, but generally speaking the entire process with that particular lens.

[02:01:21] So thank you for that. - Okay, anybody, Dr. Garan? - I just wanted to reiterate what Ms. Holden said, And thank you, Dr. Peterson, for taking that time to really work with the publishers to ensure this. And Ms. Holton, I wanna thank you because you actually brought it up here at the board level and appreciate you doing that for all of us to look deeper into this.

[02:01:43] And Dr. Peterson, besides that though, what I saw with the revisions and your presentation before, I could tell that you are leading the work through an equity lens and ensuring that. And so adding this other piece to that tool, Constantly want to add more tools to our toolbox and how we can improve that.

[02:02:02] I know that you have already done that and we'll do that for future ones. I just want to thank you. - Okay, well, thank you. - Mr. Duran, can I just respond to say, I've been channeling Ms. Lodl. This is a role she always played for us. - You have, she did.

[02:02:18] Doing it well. - Emily, go first. - Yes. - I echo everyone's sentiments without delaying your progress. - Thank you. All right. Is there a motion then to add this book to the list?

[02:02:36] - So moved. - Ms. Holton and then second. - Second. - Thank you, Dr. Wilson. Ms. Holton. - Aye. - Ms. Davis-Vaugh. - Aye. - Dr. Duran. - Aye.

[02:02:51] - Dr. Wilson. - Aye. - Dr. Mann. - Aye. - And I vote aye. Now we've been doing this about two hours. We've got a couple more items to go. I am content to push through, but also content if you want to take a 10 minute break. please sir push through push through i'm sorry miss david small was that push through or take a break take a restroom break yes i think we'll do that okay uh we'll be back at about uh 12.05

[02:03:22] thank you thank you thank you president gecker it was good for all of us

[02:12:51] so that's good we're waiting for dr duran and miss holton here sorry my computer oh no that's

[02:13:39] fine go i just i'll show you back and back good thank you miss holton are you back yes oh good

[02:14:51] okay all right then i guess we can get started again we'll move on to item l the first review of amendments to licensure regulations for school personnel etc miss pitts and miss walsh good afternoon president gecker members of the board and dr lane it is my pleasure to present the review of amendments to regulations and guidelines. This action is to amend the licensure regulations for school personnel, which are outlined in attachment A, procedural guidelines

[02:15:28] for conducting licensure hearings, please refer to attachment B, and the regulations governing the review and approval of education programs in Virginia and refer to your Board Item, page K, to comport with Virginia General Assembly legislation in the 2019 and 2020 sessions.

[02:15:53] The 2019 session speaks solely to reprimands and there are multiple revisions based upon the 2020 General Assembly. The regulations are to be revised under the fast-track rulemaking requirements of the Administrative Process Act, and that is because these are based upon legislation and are codified.

Therefore, we can use the fast-track rulemaking. Before we present the revisions and amendments, I wanted to begin with a couple of preliminary comments on the format of our

[02:16:32] presentation. In attachment A, you will see highlighted in gray text. That denotes text that is actually going through the Administrative Process Act now that was previously approved by the Board. It is to give you context, but it is not part of your action today. I will briefly overview the amendments to the licensure regulations that are highlighted in attachment A in yellow,

[02:17:06] as well as the approved program regulations changes that begin on page K in your board item. Nancy Walsh will present the proposed revisions regarding reprimands in the licensure regulations, attachment A that are highlighted in blue, and also the guidelines regarding hearings, and those are in red font, and attachment B. Now we will begin with the proposed regulatory

[02:17:41] amendments. I'm going to swiftly go through these. If you have specific questions or want more detail, please let me know, but I know that you have already reviewed this item. House Bill 1568 and senate bill 978 require that persons seeking a technical professional license with an endorsement to teach military science can have either the appropriate credential that's required by the united states military or a recommendation from a virginia employing educational agency the latter

[02:18:18] would be a non-military course in leadership if you'll reference page 8 in attachment a you will see text to address House Bill 1613 to permit any individual who seeks a technical professional license to substitute completion of an intensive job embedded three-year program of professional development that must be pre-approved by the Department of Education for the nine hours of

[02:18:49] professional studies. House Bill 1630 expands the period of time in which an extension of a license that will expire can be recommended to be changed to a renewable license. This is for individuals who hold provisional license, who've met all other requirements, who have taken all licensure tests, but who have not met all of them, may receive

[02:19:24] Under very specific criteria recommendation for a superintendent for a full license, and you can refer to that language on page four. On page three, you will see language to reflect House Bill 1469 and Senate Bill 680, which will allow schools for students with disabilities that are licensed by you by the Board of Education to request an extension. That's already allowable by

[02:19:57] superintendents in school divisions can make that request and this expands that to those schools that you license. The last bill that I would like to overview is House Bill 894.

[02:20:13] And this bill is relative to not only the licensure regulations, but also the change in the regulations governing the review and approval of education programs in Virginia. So I'm going to cover it once, but it has to be included in both sets of regulations. In this bill, it requires that for initial licensure, or if you're in a college or university program, An individual must receive instruction or training on positive behavior interventions and supports, crisis prevention and de-escalation,

[02:20:52] the use of fiscal restraint and seclusion, consistent with regulations of the Board, and appropriate alternative methods to reduce and prevent the need for the use of physical restraint and seclusion. You will see the language incorporated on page six in attachment A and on page K. I am pleased to tell you that Sam Hollins and her team actually developed the training to meet this requirement, so we're very excited about the fact that

[02:21:25] We can deliver this training and the colleges and universities have already started to use it. So unless there are any specific questions about those revisions, I would like to turn it over to Nancy Walsh and she is going to cover the information on the reprimands. But one other point of clarification is that the advisory board on teacher education licensure did review all of this information at its September meeting.

[02:21:59] So they had a full discussion, understood that these are requirements required by the statute. Thank you. Good afternoon, President Gecker, Dr. Lane, and members of the board. I'm pleased to appear before you this afternoon and provide information, as Patty said, on those amendments to the licensure regulations that address written reprimands of license holders. I also will address the revisions to the procedural guidelines for conducting licensure hearings.

[02:22:32] In providing information to you this afternoon, I will address three areas. First, I will go over the legislation both from the 2019 general assembly and the 2020 general assembly that address these pieces of legislation that address reprimand and going over the legislation i think will give you some context for the specific revisions to the licensure regulations so first we will look at legislation second i will have you turn to attachment a the section in attachment

[02:23:07] a that includes highlights in blue those are the ones that address reprimand and then very briefly the third item i will address are the changes to the procedural guidelines so first if you look at the agenda item itself agenda item l we will go over the pieces of legislation and these are summarized on page c this is section 2 on written reprimand and you will note that in 2019 the

[02:23:41] general assembly made three legislative changes relating to reprimand the first is a change to section 22.1 292.1a which allows the board to issue a written reprimand of a license holder for any of the violations of secure mandatory tests listed there so back in 2019 the general assembly identified that there could be some testing violations for which the board should

[02:24:17] have the authority to issue a written reprimand of the license holder as opposed to taking action against the license itself the second change in 2019 identified a different area where the board should have authority to issue a written reprimand and that was the change to 22.1304 which addresses employment breaches so situations in which a license holder breaches his or her employment contract and the school board does not release that license holder from a contract the legislation here was revised to allow the board to issue a written reprimand the board is not required to

[02:24:57] do that it still could revoke or suspend the license but that was added in 2019 and the third change in 2019 was a change to 22.1 to 98.1 which simply indicated that the board's regulations that the board issue regulations that include procedures for written reprimands of license holders so in 2019 we had two very narrow circumstances the secure mandatory test violations and the employment

[02:25:28] contract violations and then authority to issue regulations in 2020 um the general assembly made two additional changes with legislation and those are described in the agenda item on page d and the most important of those is the change the general assembly went back to 298.1 and significantly broadened the description of the regulations to be promulgated by the board and i'm just going to note here that the legislation requires licensure regulations

[02:26:07] include procedures for written reprimands quote on grounds established by the board of education in accordance with law. So here the General Assembly clarified that the board should have the authority to identify any circumstances as long as they are in accordance with law for which it should have

the authority to issue reprimands. And I'm noting that because the reason that the regulations were not changed sooner in response to the 2019 changes are because arguably those changes applied only to the very narrow circumstances of employment contract violation

[02:26:44] and testing violations but when the department became aware that additional legislation was underway in 2020 to make it clear that the board would have greater authority in its regulations that's why you're seeing both years of changes together the only other change made in 2020 was a very technical change to 22.1304 that added the word suspension to the contract violation cases because for some reason the code previously just referenced revocation of a license as a possible

[02:27:18] sanction for an employment contract violation so now 304 lists revocation suspension and written reprimand so that's just some background for you on the legislation that's driving these amendments i'm going to ask you now to look at attachment a as mrs pitts noted there are different colors of shading throughout this document but i am going to direct you to the shading in blue and just very briefly walk you through the licensure regulation amendments relating to reprimand the first is on page four this is just the definition of a written reprimand and as you

[02:27:58] can see it's defined very simply as a written admonishment of a license holder that does not result in withdrawal of the license on the very same page you see the definitions of revocation and suspension and those two are adverse actions against the license that do result in withdrawal one is temporary and one revocation is defined as just the withdrawal so now we're going to jump to kind of the end of the licensure regulations and really look at the heart of the revisions

[02:28:29] on page 24 there's a number of little pieces of blue throughout the document but those are mostly just citation changes based on a newly added section on written reprimand on page 24 we have a section on written reprimand and this section provides the reasons that a written reprimand may be issued by the board so the first two are the ones i already mentioned from the 2019 general assembly um for any of the violations relating to mandatory tests is specified in section 22.1

[02:29:07] 292.1 of the code the second reason is the breach of an employment contract so if the board decided that written reprimand of the license holder was appropriate it could choose to issue that reprimand the number three here um clarifies that the board is going to have significant discretion in the circumstances when it issues a written reprimand under this section of the revised regulations the board in accordance with law and at the discretion of the board after reviewing the specific facts and circumstances of a case and determining that the license holder's conduct

[02:29:47] is not sufficiently serious or harmful to merit withdrawal the board may issue a written reprimand in number three there is an exception um this references it could issue for any of the reasons listed for revocation or suspension with the exception that it cannot issue a written reprimand for a conviction of a violent felony set forth in the definition of a barrier crime or for any offense involving the sexual molestation physical or sexual abuse or rape

[02:30:20] of a child and for your information this exception this language referring to barrier crimes and sexual and physical and sexual abuse and rape of a child that language is the same as the language that was included in a recent piece of legislation that became effective this year July 1 2020.

[02:30:41] many of you may be aware that as President Gecker mentioned earlier today school divisions previously under section 22.1 296.1 were not able to employ individuals convicted of a felony any felony

this year effective July 1 the General Assembly put into effect changes to that section that clarified that a school division may it's not required to but it may employ individuals convicted of a felony as long as that felony is not a barrier crime as defined in the code

[02:31:20] or it is not one of these other offenses um listed here in the amended regs so just as school divisions may not hire individuals convicted of these types of offenses the board is not going to have the authority under the regs to just issue a reprimand if that's the type of offense that you are reviewing um the other exception here is in um b of the newly added 23 760. the board may not issue a written reprimand in cases in which it has become notified of a

[02:31:53] dismissal or resignation under section 313 and in the case of a founded case of child abuse um if it remains on the registry those of you who have heard from me during the executive session should be familiar with um language in the code in 20 22.1 to 98.1 that says the board shall revoke a license in certain circumstances this this language here tracks that so again if a case

[02:32:28] falls under those circumstances when the code requires revocation clearly the board is not going to be authorized to issue a written reprimand of the license holder so that's just the this is the actual section that deals with written reprimand procedurally i'd like to point out that this section differs from the previous sections on revocation and suspension from 720 and 740.

[02:32:56] for for revocation or suspension a petition for either of those actions is initiated by local school divisions or by Dr. Lane on behalf of the Board of Education. Written reprimand is not going to be treated similarly. It is only an action that the Board has the discretion to decide on for a license holder. We will not have, under the amended regulations as proposed to you, a situation where a school division may petition for a written reprimand it would simply be a

[02:33:36] sanction a discipline of the license holder that the board could decide decide on if this case as it determines is not sufficiently serious or harmful enough to warrant suspension or revocation the only other thing i wanted to point out to you in attachment a at the very end you do have a section on notification and so we have added written reprimand to the other license actions that are listed there for notifications so notification of revocation suspension cancellation

[02:34:11] denial or um reinstatement or the written reprimand of a license holder would be reported as indicated in that section very briefly pardon me oh i was just going to give the superintendent's recommendation okay i just wanted very briefly to look at attachment b that's the procedural guidelines for conducting licensure hearings they're very minor changes there to simply indicate um that it is another action that the board would have at its disposal one thing i

[02:34:47] wanted to mention in the section um on proceed on the panel's recommendations the investigative panel could recommend written reprimand after reviewing a case similarly dr lane could make a recommendation for reprimand after he hears about the case after the case has gone through the panel at the very end of the guidelines it mentions that the board may um issue a written reprimand i'll let patty go ahead okay thank you nancy i'm sorry i jumped in a little early the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board receive these

[02:35:27] amendments for first review okay well thank you for the presentation um are there any comments or questions at this point or are we prepared to accept it for first review dr durand thank you for that overview nancy a couple questions on the written ripper man would that be something that the

board would determine how long that's for and would it or is the written reprimand something that would always be there that would be attached to the um notification or is it for you know a certain amount um dr duran as drafted the written reprimand would not it would be just a one it's

[02:36:06] a one-time admonishment it's my understanding as drafted that it would remain as part of the individual's licensure file the same way that a suspension or a revocation or a denial would be presently we report those as you know to the nasdaq clearinghouse they remain there even if an individual's license has been reinstated um the license holder's record with nasdaq would still reflect the date he or she had a suspended license or a revoked license or we have had individuals who've been denied a license and then issued and we would report the issuance of the

[02:36:45] license but it would be um part of the permanent licensure record thank you that clarifies to be part of the permanent record so the board wouldn't be determining we're going to give you a written reprimand for six months not for it's not a set time period the same way that a suspension would be got it thank you very much appreciate that anybody else you're on mute you're on mute

[02:37:17] whoops sorry um uh section b of that uh 760 23-760 section the exception uh that creates circumstances wherein we cannot uh uh you do a written reprimand uh the subsection f of 22.1313 that refers to a circumstance where somebody's been fired with allegations of sexual misconduct

[02:37:55] is that what that is sexual misconduct it could also be as the result of a founding case of child abuse or neglect um that there's different types of notifications but one is indeed for sexual misconduct others are could be physical abuse that results in a founding case of child abuse but it's in other words it's not whenever the the local division has done dismissal or resignation not at all right okay it's a very major subset actually yep thank you appreciate it okay anybody

[02:38:29] else any comments or questions if not we will see this again next month and uh we'll accept it for first review thank you very much thank you thank you okay item m first review of the board's uh annual report good afternoon president gecker can everybody hear me i was on double mute so hopefully hopefully everybody can hear me um good afternoon president gecker dr wilson members of the board and dr lane i'm pleased to present for first review the board's 2020 annual report on the

[02:39:09] condition and needs of public schools in Virginia. As you will note in the boilerplate, this report is required by 22.1-18 of the Code of Virginia. This section outlines the requirements for the report, including the current standards of quality, information on student and parent choice, including charter school and virtual school options, as well as a report on all of the required reports that local school divisions are required to submit to the state or federal government i will note that some of these reports were in the process of being finalized when this

[02:39:43] item was posted in your board book and on the website so you do not see them in the appendices but they will be included for final review and can be provided to you in the next draft in the interim the annual report presents the needs of public education in virginia an update on the board's work over the past year and a summary of achievement of students and schools much of this report focuses on research relevant to the priorities outlined in your comprehensive plan and to the standards of quality which you unanimously re-prescribed at your September board meeting. Unless noted, staff has reviewed and revised all data points,

[02:40:23] charts, and graphs with the most recent data available. Additionally, once the text of the report is finalized, an executive summary will be added for your review and approval in November, along with more information on the board's accomplishments that have been approved this fall the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education receive for first review the 2020 annual report on the conditions and needs of public schools in virginia i'm happy to take any questions i'll also note doing this in a virtual setting is somewhat

[02:40:59] different since i know we usually have a work session on the annual report and i'm happy you know we can have a conversation now and i'm also happy to work with individual board members in between first and final review should we need to work out some language all right any preliminary comments and thank you emily for the work on this i will say as you noted being virtual has i think hurt us a little bit not in terms of the quality output but certainly in terms of the process that we've used i candidly have not been quite as diligent as i would like to be yet uh going

[02:41:35] through this uh although you know i appreciate having had the advanced copy uh you know for members of the board it is no secret that i view this as well as the comprehensive work plan as you know two very important documents i know for a long period of time the annual reports were just sort of copied over cut and paste and you know things moved on but this is one of the few times that we speak in a document form about where the board's going and what we believe.

[02:42:08] And so to the extent that you have not had a chance yet to actually go through this with some detail, I would appreciate it if you did. I know Dr. Duran, you've got your hand up. I'll get you in just a second. You know, be good within the next two weeks if we could have any comments back so that we can try to integrate this I will say the condition of schools today given you know virtual hybrid and you know some fun instruction I think needs to be highlighted it has certainly

[02:42:42] raised some issues that ought to be highlighted and although I'm comfortable with this as a first draft I think that we need to like I said pay particular attention this is you know if we are to be taken seriously then the work product here needs to be serious taken seriously and it is my desire to put out something that accurately and fully represents where we think we are in the commonwealth today dr duran thank you question emily on page 11 with regards to the number there's

[02:43:17] a comment there highlighted section and it indicates the number of english learners and in the data there, but the comment is, look at a five-year trend, the data is weird in 2010. Can you explain that to me? Yes, absolutely, and I may not be able to explain all the technicalities of it, and I probably, that was a comment for myself and probably should have been removed, but there was a different data collection for the years of 2010, school year 2010, 2011, which really skews the increases that we saw in English learner students and so when I was working

[02:43:57] with Dr. Paiva Rena on updating some of this data she had recommended that we work at look at a five-year correlation or five-year increase versus tenure because for that one year it was a different data collection that really doesn't translate well to how we've done it in the past and so I am planning to look at that and work with her to make sure that we get get those numbers correct um in between first and final review okay hopefully that makes sense

[02:44:29] anybody else thank you emily that does help appreciate that uh so emily i i'm with uh president geckering that i haven't spent as i haven't been as diligent on it as i would like to be and and we'll try to uh uh take a close read on it uh uh expeditiously and and offer you any feedback from my quicker look. I do

think, well, just one, I also want to reiterate President Gecker's remarks about how important this document is. It is how we collectively speak,

[02:45:07] and frankly, I don't know when we send it over to the General Assembly whether anybody reads it or not, but we get the opportunity to quote it, and others do too, so we can use it throughout the year in our conversations with legislators and other stakeholders and I think it and I think it is used in that capacity and is extremely valuable so some of the recitation of issues about teacher shortages for instance it establishes a record that is a basis for other actions where we don't you know we don't otherwise collectively speak to all these issues in a documented way so

[02:45:46] that's just reiterating importance i i do think there needs to be there are references to the pandemic um and i and i do think it's good that you've maintained the the long-term comprehensive plan focus and the soq the justification for the soq uh changes we have made uh but i do think the pandemic and there are references throughout to the effects of the pandemic but it's not enough there really needs to be a section up front that acknowledges um in some detail uh what you know

[02:46:24] the needs and conditions of public education in virginia right now are that x number of divisions started uh completely virtual x number of divisions are doing hybrid etc etc that the extraordinary efforts being put out by educators all across the commonwealth to try to meet the needs of families and yet that we are you know all struggling with the challenges all the efforts the department has gone through to help get this up the pandemics dashboard up oh to give guidance to the divisions and then to get this most recently this pandemic dashboard up um uh you know

[02:47:02] acknowledging all that hard work acknowledging where we are and where we aren't i think one thing that we probably ought to talk about is how the average daily membership numbers are going to to be way down this fall um and that we don't i think don't think that that's well i know we don't think that's necessarily reflective of future um adms post-pandemic though obviously nobody knows but that we and i don't know what happened in the general assembly uh budget conference that was results were posted yesterday so i don't i know there was a difference between the two houses and

[02:47:39] how much waiver they were promising the divisions on the consequences of the enrollment drop this fall in terms of budget so maybe that's been resolved for the immediate budget year in a satisfactory way but we would want to lay a foundation for discussions about that topic among others going forward and i know you will go back and update i do see you have reference to the racial justice issues and the work of the commission and i know you'll go back and update that for our work uh what we actually we took and the the hard work of the department going

[02:48:16] forward absolutely i'm happy to actually we can add a a covid pandemic section um make sure that it's front and center not a problem at all um i can work with holly and dr lame and and other staff to make sure that we we capture everything that has been going on and kind of where our school divisions are right now um and we'll can get uh another draft out to you all um even before we send out the next board book in november just something that reflects the extraordinary challenges the divisions are fake take facing the extraordinary efforts they and the department have

[02:48:54] taken to address those challenges but huge gaps remaining and uncertainty so yes that would be wonderful thank you absolutely no problem yes i also thank you for giving us a chance to look at this early on and share feedback on follow-up i'm thinking about um also trying to have some uh

representation in here around the work that's happening in early ed within the department under maybe there's a small call out there's been a tremendous number of activities that have happened

[02:49:28] to sort of bring uh this under the umbrella of ed and i think it'd be great under the equity you know the section one where we focus on equity that maybe have a call out around that i realize uh that we're still at the very early stages of of having that work more fully integrated within the department but there certainly has been a fair bit of a progress along that path and seeing that called out more actually i'm sure will will help people appreciate that um this is this is this is

[02:50:02] also important work that's being done within it so absolutely happy to to work with with jenna and her team on on adding some information about early childhood anybody else james do you know where the budget language came out with regard to the you know holding schools harmless for adm yes uh that did not make it through the special session uh what they did there is actually asked us not to adjust the adm payments but to come back to them in january with more information following the

[02:50:38] september 30th report it wasn't ready by the time they were starting to wrap up the budget uh and so uh my my gut feeling is that they'll take that issue back up in january uh and um what i can tell you today is our analysis of it uh has it budget neutral from the state uh obviously if it if there's no hold harmless it would be significantly impactful to school districts but uh the money is there to make up the gap and the loss of students because we budgeted for a higher number of students and so um more to follow in january can't speak to the governor's position

[02:51:14] on it can't speak to what the general assembly will do but i think um i think that'll be a big topic in january but it is a an opportunity or actually i think almost a mandate for us to speak to it in terms of what the impact of effectively not holding them harmless would be for the locals i mean wasn't the uh the sba number like 150 million on the whole harmless it was a big number as i recall and i would say that that's a that's an unofficial number but yes the vast did produce a number that was closer to 150 million that would be lost revenue for school districts and

[02:51:51] of course we have that revenue sitting in the budget currently so it's really a policy issue right in other words they have not reality yes you can speak to it they have not reallocated that money to other pieces yet is what you're saying when you see no they have not okay and so i do think it's important in terms of the policy i mean the impact of that loss would be significant you know you know jeez uh you can't and you can't plan this way either if you're a local it makes it very very difficult dr man i agree you're speaking but you're are there things that

[02:52:31] can well i'm asking this perhaps i think that's a very important point um and i think uh to the extent that there are things that can be done um individually or collectively by the board to express an opinion on this when you read the condition of schools and see we're already at a c minus when it comes to finance and education and the reality of the work being so much more intensive under these circumstances to say nothing of the comment you made about planning uh because we don't know what's going to be required as we move through the rest of this

[02:53:08] year so i i sort of uh would be interested in thinking about what what is within our realm to collectively uh state on that point it's a very important um it's a very important concern anybody else have any comments on this emily i know you're taking notes so i'm not even going to ask so um president geffer just one minor point um to expand on what dr mann is saying the impact

[02:53:44] is of of covid loss of revenue all of those things are right now certainly into next semester or um but i am concerned that we perhaps lay a marker for the ongoing the longer term the the lag the tail of the impact of covid we can't see it yet and i i so to to somehow acknowledge that the um that the condition of our schools potentially may feel the effects of covid for much longer than

[02:54:18] any of us can now see um so that we give ourselves space to as we learn more we heard from uh superintendents a couple or a month ago we've heard from organizations just yesterday in our um our committee meeting i i think we're going to continue to see those impacts and we should lay a marker i think now so that in this report so we can pick it up in future years if necessary okay now we've all most of us have expressed some ideas that are going to go into this report

[02:54:52] it is manifestly unfair for us to just assume that emily can capture what you have in your mind so it is incumbent upon us to you know actually take the time i'm not asking you to draft the report but to make more detailed notes about what it is we think is important you think is important so that they can be incorporated uh and also to do that fairly quickly you know within the next week would be awesome uh and i can work with emily or somebody who writes better than i do can work with emily to uh you know flesh this out and hopefully a draft that'll make it through the

[02:55:31] next meeting uh but this is time sensitive uh it is as i said going into this i think particularly important uh that we lay it out you know a lot of what we do as you know is seemingly ignored uh you know i've felt for a while now bad that my you know favorite thing we've done the soqs seem to be ignored but yet i go places and people say to me you guys did great work on this they'll catch up to you and so you know wrong to think that what we say just goes into some big hole

[02:56:05] somewhere never to be heard of again i think we need to create the echo uh and that will resonate and eventually change minds about where we need to be so uh i have nothing else to say on this honestly other than you know i have told people and i believe it strongly we are the hardest working board in the commonwealth certainly the hardest working unpaid board in the commonwealth and you know this is one of those times where that hard work needs to be uh you know put out

[02:56:39] so that's the charge anybody else on this thanks i'm gonna say uh thank you president gecker for that you know i have taken a lot of notes and um will certainly capture as much as i can but you know even bulleted notes from board members um would certainly be helpful to make sure that we we get this in a good form before it goes to final review in november okay thank you all um items N and O are written reports. You can read those at your leisure. And we move on to discussion

[02:57:16] of current items. Are there any other items that we have not hit upon in this meeting that we'd like to talk about? Dr. Lane. Thank you, Mr. Gecker. Just a couple things, and some of this will come back to you in your next board meeting, but we sent the board a copy by email of the JLARC report on the operations and management of the department of education uh whereas that report even as stated by jlark was overwhelmingly positive it certainly gave us some areas to improve on uh and i just want to ensure the board we're we're working on those matters updating our strategic plan

[02:57:51] we'll have a brief for you that on that the next time we get together um i uh i also um uh want to uh as i always do give you an update on uh the status of what's going on in schools as it relates to the pandemic i i try to be brief here but i will tell you um the since the last time we got together the vdh has released a new pandemic dashboard that you can go to on their website i search um pandemic dashboard and then it's got a tab for cdc metrics that's really guiding a lot

[02:58:27] of the school divisions thinking around uh the data in their home communities cdc has two core metrics one is you know essentially cases over 14 days the others percent positivity and then they have sub core metrics and then requirements that school divisions meet mitigation strategies but as we've started reporting that data and school divisions are starting to assess that it's more safe I did want to let you know that we are seeing a trend that more school divisions are starting to implement at a minimum the hybrid model we recommend essentially that if you're in the highest

[02:59:04] risk of transmission that you go back to our phase one guidelines uh in coordination with vdh if you're in the moderate to high risk category we recommend that you implement phase two guidelines and if you're in the lower lower category we recommend phase three uh guidelines as a reminder phase three is essentially every student as long as you meet the physical distancing requirements and masking and cleaning and health and everything else phase two is a focus on early childhood special education and el learners english language learners and and then phase one of course focuses

[02:59:41] on it getting our special education students their services and so with that transition to more school divisions going back we're continuing to adjust our support and technical assistance school divisions and meeting with superintendents on a regular basis my daughter today got on a bus at 9 13 a.m to travel to school for the first time that she's been in person since march my home school division allowed k2 back a little early and then the older students will come back later but the excitement on our face was certainly palpable for our family and but our school divisions are

[03:00:21] continuing to make decisions about what's safest some school divisions have certainly taken a more measured approach their data calls for it their staffing needs call for it and so we're continuing to monitor that we'll be doing a new update to our map on November 6th to give you a sense of exactly what every school division is doing with this latest round of enhancements I can go into way more detail on any of those but I know you've been at this for a long time and so that's the highest level overview i can give and i thank you for the uh the moment thank you now james could

[03:00:56] you would you mind addressing something that at least for me was counterintuitive when we heard it we were on a call the other day with a division superintendent who indicated that the uh uh full virtual the five-day virtual actually what might yield better academic results than the blended model uh and i think you mentioned to me that that may be consistent with other research coming out as I said because it took me aback as somewhat counterintuitive and maybe it shouldn't have been it might be worth addressing yeah thank you uh and I I would not um I would not say that

[03:01:35] we have peer-reviewed research to support this uh and so uh there there are some reports coming from other states but so know that I think we'll need time to to say that the research fully supports this but there are parents questioning probably is the best way for me to say it whether two days of in-person instruction in the hybrid model and then essentially because the teacher has to teach the other half of the students the rest of the week the student is essentially asynchronous the rest of the week that's the most popular hybrid model whereas students will go on monday tuesday the school will do a deep clean on wednesday the other half of the

[03:02:14] class essentially goes on thursday friday that's the most popular hybrid model that essentially give students two full days of direct instruction with their teacher and three asynchronous days um there are a lot of questions about whether that is equally as effective or more effective than having your teacher with you all day every day five days a week in the virtual setting and and frankly i think the the best advice

that i could give a school district on that is it depends it depends on how well you're doing your mitigation strategies it depends on how how well you're you're

[03:02:49] doing with your virtual program it depends on the frankly the poverty of the family and what access they have to the internet and and the the quality of the resources that they're provided but it also depends on the age of the student i've had great conversations with miss davis fought she will tell you i think unequivocally that the earliest learners definitely benefit from that in person uh even if it's just one or two days a week uh and so you know there are a lot of factors there before i would come out with a hard recommendation on that but i don't think that

[03:03:24] we should uh completely pan if you will the virtual setting because there are some benefits to the length of time that students are engaging together and with the teacher and so i think we are our measure that we've taken at department to really allow this to be a local focus based on the context of their data their you know their students situations is is uh is probably the the best strategy moving forward but there there are benefits and negatives to every model that's not five days a week in person with the teacher you know because of the pandemic and we're not

[03:04:01] recommending five days a week with every student in person with the teacher because of safety reasons but um in the context of the options that school divisions have i think they're making decisions in the best interest of their communities the overarching point is that we need do, I think keep good watch on this and the data that comes out, act as the clearing house and perhaps act as the advice giving agency for, you know, if this continues, how it ought to continue.

[03:04:29] And also, frankly, you know, since you know my heightened concern over the quality of virtual learning and the disparity between quality, you know, in different places, continuing to look for best practices as we see them, see where we get results and perhaps throw them out as a statewide model and thank you i i just wanted to add one point i didn't say and that is i i think the board will be pleased to hear we are working on your quarterly reports that you requested as part of the 990 waiver process and i know the president vice president have a draft of the types of things

[03:05:05] we're going to collect coming uh but um the the quality of virtual i can say unequivocally now six months later is much better than what our students were experiencing in march april and may the school divisions did a great job of training teachers over the summer i think that you know when it's safe in person is always going to be uh you know i i think the goal for our school divisions but even anecdotally with my own children talking to school divisions sending in on virtual seeing in person uh the board should be pleased with the progress our school divisions are making to make

[03:05:44] virtual as high quality as it can be right now. And I think that I know you've had concerns, Mr. Gecker, but I've been proud of what I've seen thus far. Good. Anybody else? Any comments, questions, or additions? If not, I'd like to thank everybody. Dr. Duran, I'm sorry.

[03:06:05] Just a quick acknowledgement, a reminder that in 2009 that the General Assembly designated October around the Commonwealth as Disability History and Awareness Month, and I know that VDOE and Superintendent Lane had sent out some information to school divisions and just want to remind us all as we think about that to honor and contributions and achievements of people with disabilities this month and there's a lot of great online activities that are happening through VDOE so thank you Dr. Lane and the VDOE staff for putting those out and just wanted to acknowledge that thank you Mr. President thank you anybody else yes I feel sure

[03:06:45] that i have some staff members who would enjoy inviting you to zoom sessions and lessons if you'd like to do that i actually asked the last superintendent we were on the phone with dames and i if i could do that i get to receive my invitation so yeah i'd love to do that fam thank you you're welcome i think that's it uh one day i hope to see you guys in person again but i think next month we'll probably be back uh doing it in the family zoom context so uh thank you all for your time and attention this morning and we'll see you soon thank you president thank you great to be with you everybody



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